Digital Commons EDIC

ADOPTED

Implementation Strategy

2026-2027

Connect actors and needs,
deploy digital commons
and maintain them at scale.

Adopted by the Assembly of Members

ASSEMBLY	FIRST CYCLE	REVIEW
16 October 2026	**2026-2027**	**End of 2027**
Adopted	Delivery and evidence	Review results and next steps

Reading guide

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How to read

Sections 1-2 explain the mandate and strategic choices. Sections 3-5 describe Connect, Deploy and Maintain. Sections 6-9 set out the portfolio, responsibilities, resources and evaluation. The annexes map statutory and EDCOM requirements and provide the review and indicator frameworks.

Assembly

Adopted on **16 October 2026**.

Executive Summary

Europe has strong open-source communities, public-sector initiatives, companies, maintainers and technical resources. Wider adoption remains difficult: needs, expertise and deployment experience are scattered across countries and organisations. Teams repeatedly solve similar integration and procurement problems, while demand, support and maintenance priorities remain hard to coordinate.

The Digital Commons European Digital Infrastructure Consortium (DC-EDIC) will organise European cooperation to connect these actors and needs, deploy digital commons and maintain them at scale. It will preserve national choice, open contribution and fair participation across the ecosystem. The DC-EDIC maintains the shared agenda and comparable evidence; the best-placed actors deliver, once their proposed roles and resources are confirmed.

Three priorities will guide the 2026-2027 cycle:

- **Connect:** establish light European coordination to bring needs, expertise, resources and contributions together around shared problems.
- **Deploy:** implement complete user journeys to make adoption repeatable and develop reusable components, interfaces and methods, preserving solution diversity and choice.
- **Maintain:** assess critical dependencies and strengthen their resilience through long-term care and targeted funding.

Work can start with any function. Shared needs can prompt deployment; use can reveal maintenance needs; dependency findings can change a deployment choice. Evidence can redirect priorities at any stage.

The first cycle has **eight expected results**: seven operating products or services and a Future Domains Roadmap for assessing later options and deciding which to pursue. Each identifies its users or decision-makers, the result expected by end-2027 and the evidence needed to evaluate it.

EDCOM provides the first funded programme: community activities, a one-stop shop, strategic dependency assessments, the EU Sovereign Tech Fund Pilot (EU-STF Pilot) and 100-day challenges. The Strategy brings them together around common results, within EDCOM's contractual governance.

The **Collaborative Workspace is the first proposed deployment flagship**, bringing contributors together to improve everyday tools, trusted interoperability and shared components that sustain a diverse European market. Document collaboration and messaging provide the initial use cases; meetings remain to be confirmed. Work will combine component improvements with integration, adoption and long-term care.

The **EU-STF Pilot**, operated by the Sovereign Tech Agency within EDCOM, will test European financing for selected critical open-source dependencies. Working with trusted maintainers, it will assess public benefit and support efficiency, with proportionate reporting and accountability. Maintain also covers dependency assessment, security and long-term continuity beyond the pilot.

The first cycle will produce early results and use experience to improve them, concentrating limited resources where work demonstrates value. Success will be judged by:

- **coordinated action and European capacity:** assessed needs and contributions lead to action, shared findings inform decisions, and countries and ecosystem actors reuse results;
- **adoption and deployment:** organisations use open-source solutions in routine work, and shared improvements make deployment repeatable elsewhere;
- **maintenance and resilience:** supported critical dependencies improve in remediation, continuity, maintainer capacity or adoption confidence.

By end-2027, the Assembly will review the portfolio and decide what follows, including whether the DC-EDIC's own contribution justifies the coordination effort. Each intervention should provide reusable methods, findings, relationships or delivery capacity. Together, these results should strengthen Europe's capacity to develop, deploy and sustain digital commons.

1. Mandate And Strategic Objective

1.1 The Mandate

Article 24 of the DC-EDIC Statutes requires an Implementation Strategy covering actions and timelines; roles and responsibilities; resources; governance and stakeholder contributions; implementation arrangements; milestones, targets and deliverables; key performance indicators; and risks.

Article 3 and Annex V define the wider tasks: build a European community around digital commons, facilitate access to funding and support, support maintenance and scaling, contribute to strategic developments and organise collaboration on concrete projects.

This Strategy sets first-cycle priorities within that mandate. It identifies which needs come first, how the tasks reinforce one another and where limited European resources and expertise can have the greatest effect.

1.2 The Policy And Delivery Context

The Statutes and Annex V establish the Strategy's legal and political mandate. EDCOM provides its initial delivery base; the European Commission's Open Source Strategy sets the wider policy context.

EDCOM funds community building, the one-stop shop, strategic dependency mapping, preparatory EU-STF work and 100-day challenges. The DC-EDIC will build on them within the programme's existing governance and contractual framework.

The Commission's Strategy links open source to sovereignty, resilience, public-sector capacity and competitiveness. Within its mandate and capacity, the DC-EDIC contributes by deploying secure alternatives with Member States, sustaining strategic European assets, and jointly identifying and developing reusable open digital assets. The Commission's supply- and demand-side measures inform the priorities for first-cycle tests. Results from those tests will inform decisions on which European capabilities to sustain or expand beyond 2027.

Rapid technological change requires adaptable instruments. Artificial intelligence (AI) is changing software production, testing, documentation, security and support, while cybersecurity obligations are strengthening. Cloud, identity, mobile-device and collaboration architectures are evolving; procurement and licensing practices face renewed scrutiny. The Strategy maintains a stable direction while adapting its instruments to experience and findings.

1.3 The Central Objective

The objective for 2026-2027 is:

> **Build the European capacity to connect actors and needs, deploy digital commons and maintain them at scale.**

Dependable open-source adoption requires resources now spread across many actors: technical assets, procurement and integration expertise, deployment environments, support capacity and dependency evidence. Coordinating them

around shared needs can reduce repeated work, remove adoption barriers and gather enough demand to sustain dependable integration, support and maintenance.

Shared work can make a practical difference. An infrastructure component can reduce duplicated integration across countries; a tested procurement method can reduce uncertainty for buyers and suppliers. Dependency evidence can direct maintenance support, and a reusable deployment pattern can give a new participant a tested starting point.

Member States gain from reuse, faster access to tested methods, stronger negotiating power through credible alternatives and continuity for capabilities supporting public services. Common requirements can make European demand clearer to software companies. These effects strengthen European agency: the ability to understand, adapt, deploy, support and replace critical capabilities.

The DC-EDIC will strengthen the actors already doing this work. Member States retain policy and procurement choice; communities and maintainers retain technical agency. Companies, integrators, hosters and support providers remain essential to delivery. The DC-EDIC sustains the common agenda, makes evidence comparable, coordinates responsibilities and preserves continuity across projects and countries.

1.4 A Focused First Cycle

The first cycle runs from Assembly validation to end-2027: enough time to deliver services and pilots, within a credible horizon for a fast-changing field. It establishes the operating model through tangible results using available resources and delivery arrangements.

The end-2027 findings will shape the next work programme: which capabilities to continue, scale or extend into other statutory tasks. The Future Domains Roadmap keeps later needs available for assessment and decision.

Each intervention starts from a shared need or dependency, uses the smallest useful response and supports a decision on what follows. The best-placed actor delivers it. The DC-EDIC relies on partners' existing expertise, relationships and funded responsibilities, acting directly where shared accountability, evidence or governance needs a responsible European body. A proposed contribution is available only after the actor confirms its role and resources.

Connect, Deploy and Maintain have equal strategic standing. Their budgets, maturity, timetables and direct DC-EDIC workload reflect the smallest useful proof, available funded instruments, confirmed partner capacity and evidence needed for the next decision. Focus prevents effort dispersing across an activity catalogue; shared results make pilots useful beyond their original setting.

2. Strategic Logic And Principles

2.1 The Operating-Capacity Gap

Adoption at scale requires open-source code and the capacity to integrate, use and sustain it. Organisations need interoperability, security, usability, support and maintenance suited to their context. They also need credible migration, appropriate procurement terms, integration expertise and continuity when a component or supplier changes.

The knowledge and means are distributed. A community may need procurement expertise; an administration, integration support; an integrator, a common reference profile. A funder may support maintenance when evidence identifies dependencies blocking adoption.

Repeated national effort and deployment gaps weaken common demand. Integrators, support providers and maintainers become harder to sustain, reducing adoption confidence and reinforcing dependency on established proprietary offers.

The DC-EDIC links needs, delivery and dependencies around real cases. Component ownership stays distributed; the DC-EDIC coordinates interfaces and responsibilities and makes evidence usable.

2.2 Three Strategic Priorities

Connect organises light European coordination to turn distributed needs, expertise and contributions into joint action. It qualifies requests, connects peers and experts, maps actors and capabilities, and gathers adoption knowledge and findings for decisions.

Deploy uses end-to-end use cases to build repeatable adoption paths and reusable components, interfaces and adoption resources, preserving solution diversity and choice. Defined user journeys focus each flagship; targeted challenges address blockers exposed by real deployment.

Maintain combines dependency intelligence, stewardship and targeted financing to strengthen the resilience of critical digital commons over time. It draws on deployment evidence, maintainer knowledge and public-interest priorities to pilot proportionate support, continuity and financing responses.

Each function has its own instruments and proofs. A dependency assessment can change a deployment choice; a maintenance signal can prompt a coalition or use case. Every substantial intervention will state what must be connected, what will be deployed and what must be maintained.

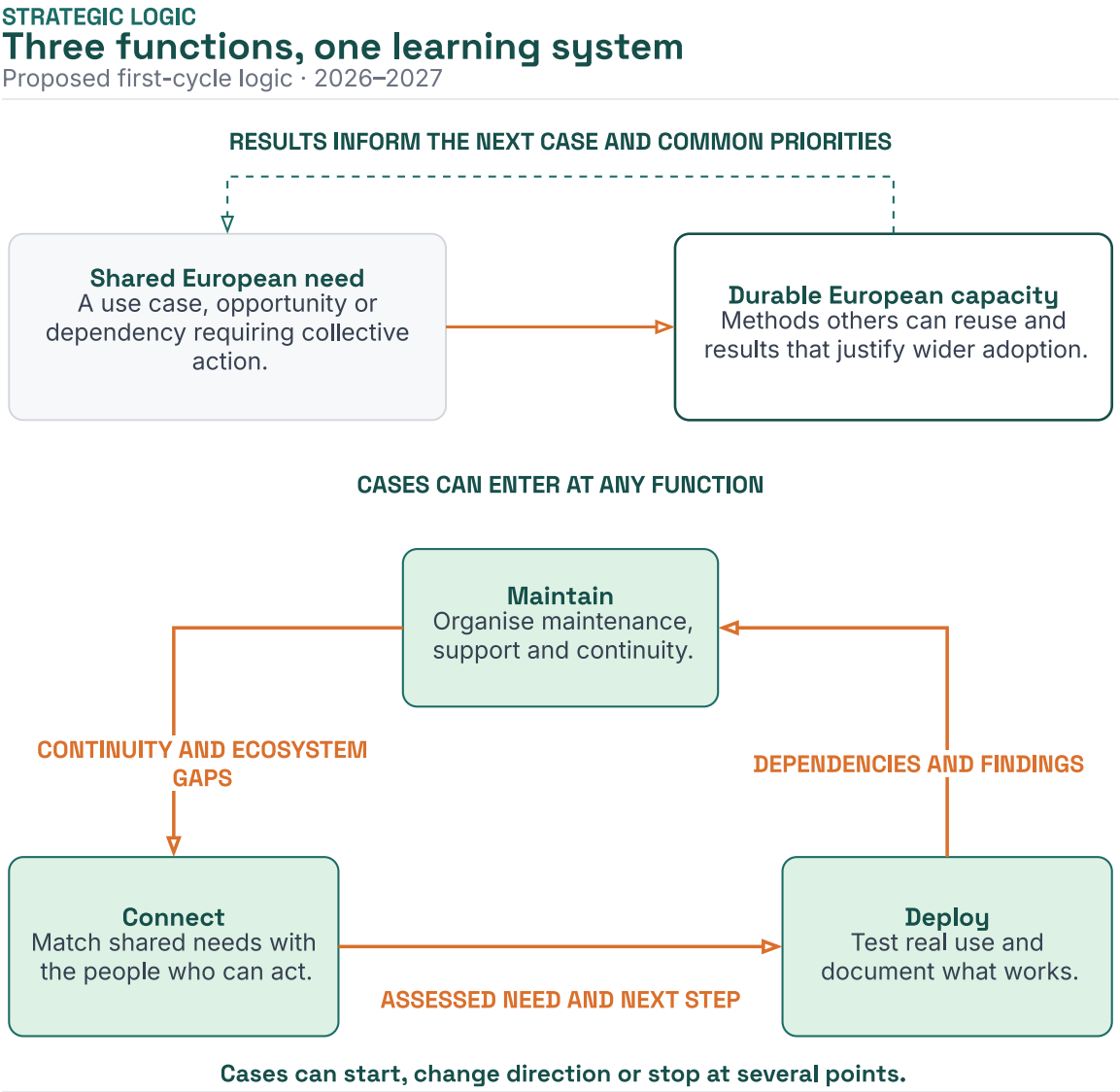


Figure 1: Connect, Deploy and Maintain learn from one another. Work may start, change direction or stop at several points; each case contributes knowledge and methods that others can use.

2.3 Shared Conditions For Adoption

The DC-EDIC will concentrate on conditions where shared European action can materially improve adoption: user journeys and acceptance criteria; interoperability profiles, open standards and conformance tests; procurement, migration and adoption methods; maturity, support and maintenance criteria; dependency and public-value evidence; and review decisions.

Common requirements allow convergence while preserving choice. Different components and national configurations can meet them. A reference implementation may demonstrate that requirements work together; subsequent selection continues to follow shared evidence and criteria.

Sharing can take different forms at each technical layer. Common standards and tests support compatible implementations but require continuing specification and conformance work. A common codebase allows shared development and corrections while creating common dependencies and maintenance choices. Open

interfaces keep components replaceable. Partners choose the form that best serves users, balancing autonomy, integration, coordination and lifecycle costs.

Reusing a component means adopting existing software. Pooling effort means sharing resources or responsibilities for development, maintenance, testing or operation. Joint support can strengthen the community already sustaining a widely reused component.

2.4 Principles For Implementation

All Strategy activities follow these principles.

Subsidiarity. Address shared needs, create reusable value or resolve coordination problems more efficiently at European level than through separate national or project action. Responsibility for delivery stays with the best-placed teams and communities. Strengthen suitable existing capabilities and support initiatives that explore better approaches.

Openness and neutrality. Select and assess through transparent criteria, open standards and fair contribution routes. Guard against hidden product endorsement or capture by a supplier, country or community.

Reliability. Support adoption claims with evidence on security, support, maintenance, continuity and operating responsibility.

Usability. Treat user experience, accessibility and organisational adoption as technical quality. Demonstrate that people can use and operate the solution effectively.

European capacity. Strengthen European communities, maintainers, product companies, integrators, hosters and support providers so they can deliver and sustain digital commons around real demand.

Multiplier effect. Focus on shared assets and decisions that mobilise partners' expertise and resources and improve conditions for wider investment and adoption. Generic foundations serving similar, stable needs across products are strong candidates for shared development and maintenance. Product diversity can improve workflows, user experience and capabilities.

Evidence and iteration. Use pilots to deliver and learn. Test credible hypotheses of user benefit through bounded experiments. Base continued investment and wider deployment on observed results and credible maintenance. Each pilot defines its decision, evidence and conditions for stopping, adjusting or scaling.

Proportionate operation. Match technical convergence and shared responsibility to the intended result. Use governance and reporting to protect public value and support timely delivery, treating administrative burden as an implementation risk.

2.5 Collective Action

The DC-EDIC combines collective action with distributed delivery. A core group of Member State partners and communities shares its objectives. A small coordinating function maintains their common agenda and evidence, preserves continuity and keeps activities focused on shared outcomes. It clarifies decision rights and supports regular communication around decisions. Partners retain room to act and clear accountability.

3. Connect: From Distributed Capacity To Coordinated Action

3.1 Purpose

Connect will help European actors find the expertise and support needed to act. Knowledge is spread across public administrations, communities, foundations, universities, companies, integrators, hosters, Open Source Programme Offices (OSPOs), funders and European programmes. Needs and contribution offers often fail to reach an actor able to respond.

During the first cycle, Connect will route qualified European needs, barriers and contribution offers to expertise, procurement support, deployment actions, maintainers, funding instruments or governance decisions.

It serves both demand and supply. Public and private organisations need help adopting and operating digital commons. Communities, maintainers and European suppliers need clearer demand signals, contribution routes, and access to deployment environments and expertise. Connect brings them together around concrete cases.

The first cycle will test whether this light structure advances real cases and makes findings from different sources useful for common decisions. Success means progress from a qualified need to a useful next step. Directory size, contacts, events and reports are supporting activity measures.

3.2 The Minimum Connect Offer

The first cycle will concentrate on three linked services.

Qualified intake and routing. The one-stop shop will receive European use cases, support and expertise requests, adoption barriers, dependency needs and contribution offers. It will qualify each request and route it to the most credible existing support through national or local nodes, EDCOM partners, experts and communities, procurement resources, challenges, EU-STF or other European instruments. Decisions requiring DC-EDIC governance will go to the competent level.

Access will be online, complemented where useful by events, nodes and partner facilities. The expertise hub will begin with active EDCOM and Strategy cases, providing guidance or referrals where credible expertise is available. Its scope will grow as expertise and capacity are confirmed.

The service will reuse European and national catalogue records, including the EU Open Source Solutions Catalogue, through links, shared metadata and technical federation where access and reuse conditions permit. It will add case qualification, evidence and a practical next step, using structured metadata such as publiccode.yml where useful.

For adoption cases, qualification will cover the user need, demonstrated maturity, deployment conditions, available security and conformity evidence, support providers, support and maintenance responsibilities and procurement routes. Information will be dated and its limitations explicit.

Cooperation with the Open Internet Stack and public-sector Open Source Programme Offices will connect users to existing discovery, assessment, support

and deployment services. The DC-EDIC will qualify needs, refer cases and add support where a gap is established. Regular operational exchanges with counterparts will clarify service boundaries, referrals, responsibilities and reusable evidence as services develop.

A first-cycle journey may connect a community, open-source software steward, manufacturer or user with competent legal, security, remediation, service or funding support for a Cyber Resilience Act (CRA) need. Referrals will respect existing statutory responsibilities and the competence of conformity authorities.

Shared adoption resources. The DC-EDIC will test a small set of resources against recurring needs from active cases, starting with partners' reviewed methods, migration playbooks, deployment evidence and expert referrals. Procurement guidance, model clauses, rulebooks, trust and data-governance patterns or training material may follow as use cases, competent owners and resources are confirmed. Maintained resources will have owners, review arrangements and reuse conditions.

Where several components must form one service, this work may test service-integration and common procurement models. These will preserve open competition, component substitutability, transparent responsibilities and a credible maintenance route.

Selected procurement resources will be tested with buyers and providers on a real case before wider dissemination. Validated elements may form a reusable toolkit for Member States and interested organisations, separating common methods from necessary national adaptations.

Use-case actor and capability map. For active requests and Strategy use cases, the DC-EDIC will map adopters, product teams, communities, maintainers, integrators, hosters, security and procurement expertise, and other capabilities needed. The map will identify availability and gaps, matching each case to the capabilities it needs. It will grow with the cases handled and retain evidence for portfolio decisions.

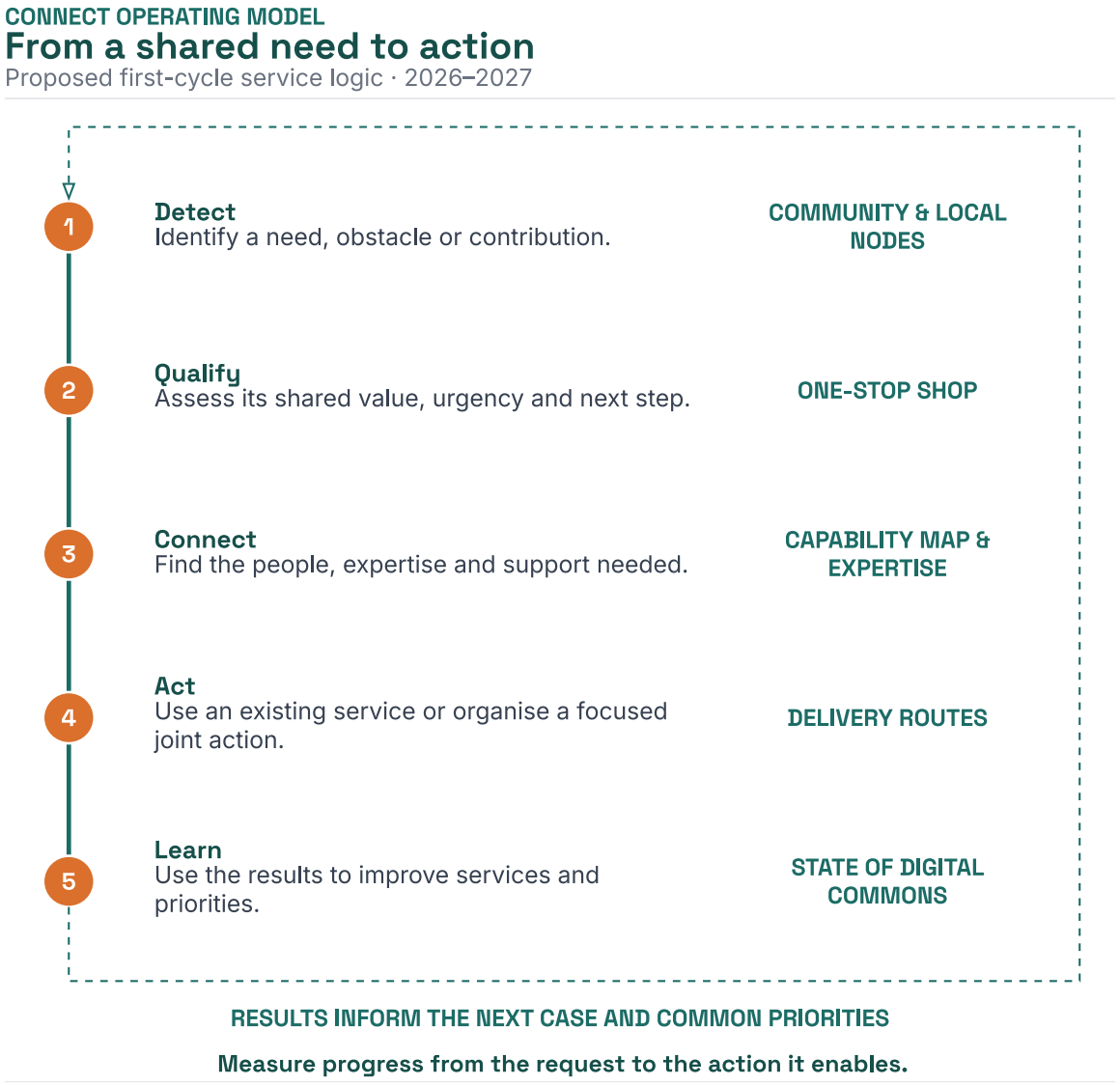


Figure 2: Connect links shared needs to expertise and action, then uses the results to improve support and common priorities.

3.3 Community Network And Local Nodes

The Community Network will connect actors to share cases, expertise and evidence. Voluntary local nodes may coordinate national, regional, sectoral or thematic participation where a capable organisation is willing to convene actors, qualify needs or support participation.

Nodes will follow common participation and evidence principles; formal governance rights remain those of the Statutes. They can make European cooperation accessible across languages, administrative levels and levels of maturity.

EDCOM WP2 supports initial network coordination, shared methods and contact points. National and local conveners connect users and contributors; the designated DC-EDIC representative ensures alignment with common priorities and European activities. Member State representatives and contact points help identify shared needs, drawing first on contributions received. The Director and team compare converging requirements and gaps with members and delivery partners to inform

priorities under Sections 6 and 8. Countries can contribute users, expertise or test cases regardless of whether they bring a product team or funding.

Peer exchanges, workshops and communication support Connect when they help solve cases, spread reusable methods or build trust for delivery. Their value lies in the resulting action and reuse. Communication on results and successful cases will make delivery evidence available to a wider audience.

Connect will help maintainers share practices and access expertise; Maintain will address specific dependencies' continuity needs.

Member States and partners may form regional or thematic acceleration groups around concrete cases. Their methods and outputs should remain open to wider participation and reusable across the Community Network.

3.4 State Of Digital Commons

The State of Digital Commons will provide a concise annual synthesis of identified needs, relevant initiatives and lessons from Strategy activities. It will draw on existing project reporting, Member State and observer knowledge, and selected research, concentrating analysis on findings that change portfolio, contribution or governance decisions.

Significant developments may prompt targeted updates between editions. Recommendations will identify their sources, scope and intended audience. Work will remain proportionate to delivery priorities, while EDCOM outputs retain their agreed timetable.

3.5 First-Cycle Results

By the end of 2027, Connect will demonstrate that:

- qualified needs and contribution offers can reach useful next steps with limited administrative burden;
- active cases reuse reviewed adoption guidance, deployment lessons or expert referrals, with procurement work tied to confirmed owners and resources;
- active use cases have credible actor and capability maps;
- the Community Network and selected local nodes improve access to expertise and participation;
- recurring ecosystem evidence informs portfolio and governance decisions.

Expansion beyond this lean minimum offer will require repeated demand, a credible owner and confirmed resources.

4. Deploy: Making Adoption Work End To End

4.1 Purpose And Target Model

Deploy aims to give Member States and European organisations open-source alternatives they can deploy at scale in key domains.

The DC-EDIC will define specific use cases in priority domains. With partners, it will select mature software and components and mobilise the integration, operating and maintenance capacity to deploy and sustain them.

Users and operators will validate solutions through concrete journeys covering integration, identity and permissions, security and compliance, accessibility and user experience, procurement and migration, organisational adoption, support and maintenance. Priority will go to improvements in components, interfaces and methods that other organisations can reuse.

Transparent criteria, open standards and interfaces, replaceable components and shared tests will govern selection. Other actors can contribute and other solutions can meet the same requirements. Organisations retain the ability to switch solutions. Deployment findings will establish readiness, remaining barriers and choices to revisit. The approach can be repeated in other domains.

4.2 First-Cycle Scope: Collaborative Workspace

The first proposed flagship will improve collaborative knowledge work across organisations and countries. Five objectives guide the programme:

1. **Better tools for everyday work.** Improve quality, accessibility, ease of use and continuity between tools, including useful AI assistance under user control.
2. **European interoperability that preserves trust.** Enable collaboration across independently governed environments, with reliable identities, clear permissions and control over information.
3. **A diverse and innovative European market.** Give communities and companies, including smaller providers, common foundations for differentiated products and services, while preserving users' ability to change tools or providers.
4. **Shared, high-quality building blocks maintained for the long term.** Align technical priorities and contributions to development, integration, end-to-end testing, security and lifecycle care, reducing duplicated effort where joint work proves more effective.
5. **A contributing coalition around a common brand.** Bring States, product teams, maintainers, providers and adopters together around a shared roadmap and concrete contributions. The programme brand will identify this effort and its results alongside participating product brands, under Section 8.5.

Members outside EDCOM can contribute alongside its funded work. Nationally managed resources may support agreed common projects; participating teams confirm their contributions and retain their product and deployment choices.

The initial use-case tracks are:

Track	User journey	What should work across configurations
Document	Co-edit, share and export a document with another organisation.	Find, open and share the same document with explicit permissions, then export it in a portable format.

Track	User journey	What should work across configurations
Communication	Message project participants and receive relevant mentions and notifications.	Users on independently governed servers can join a shared room under mutually recognised access and trust policies, with clear user and administrator controls.
Meeting (TBC)	Join from the project space and retain authorised notes, recording, transcript or summary.	Meeting outputs remain traceable, appropriately accessible and linked to relevant project resources.

A first document proof would test creating, inviting, co-editing, sharing and portable export in at least two controlled reference environments representing distinct organisational and national settings. Tests will cover identity and permissions, and, where transition requires it, coexistence with incumbent formats, calendars and workflows.

The Matrix protocol offers an emerging route for Communication; Meeting remains in discovery. A validated shared gap may justify assessing a reusable videoconferencing layer, such as a selective forwarding unit.

Across modular tools or pre-integrated suites, journeys should preserve identity, permissions, context and authorised outputs, considering shared resource addressing, events and audit conventions. The flagship will establish **a shared reference of interfaces, tests, reproducible configurations and operating conditions**. Partners will develop it within the DC-EDIC's validated common framework and choose delivery arrangements.

4.3 Choosing Interventions For Shared Value

The DC-EDIC and partners will use a consistent, proportionate approach to selecting technologies, standards and delivery partners: start from a validated user need, compare feasible options against the portfolio criteria and explain the choice through existing programme records.

Selection will favour **the strongest shared user benefit relative to full lifecycle costs and risks**, considering European added value and partner capabilities. Interventions may support upstream improvements, shared components and interoperability, or procurement, migration and adoption.

Shared foundations merit joint development where needs converge; distinct products can improve usability, capability or resilience. Support will favour open, modular assets that serve several solutions and remain replaceable under common tests. Projects and maintainers will agree contributions, integration and maintenance arrangements. Product owners retain responsibility for product-specific development and fixes; shared dependency weaknesses go to Maintain.

Where shared needs justify joint effort, the DC-EDIC will seek cooperation with the Open Internet Stack (OIS), relevant EDICs and other ecosystem actors to identify and develop reusable open digital assets. Contributions will build on existing assets and community work. Each will enter the existing portfolio with a receiving owner, clear reuse conditions and validated resources.

4.4 Delivering Through 100-Day Challenges

First-cycle challenges will improve existing open-source components where needed to complete qualified use cases. Priority goes to general-purpose commons serving several solutions, such as BlockNote for collaborative editing or Matrix for real-time communication.

Member States and partners may initiate independently funded 100-day challenges within the agreed strategic framework through a simple notification procedure. Formal DC-EDIC approval is only required where central resources are involved or where the challenge is to become part of the official DC-EDIC portfolio.

Challenges involving central resources or seeking inclusion in the official DC-EDIC portfolio follow the two-phase process below:

Qualification. Proposals from Member States and observers, EDCOM partners, users, product teams, maintainers or Connect are assessed for need, European added value and feasibility. The phase ends with an **approved launch brief** covering:

- **Result and approach:** the intended result and user benefit, blocker to resolve in 100 days, reusable intervention, feasible alternatives within programme scope and chosen form of sharing.
- **People and resources:** participating users and environments, delivery lead, confirmed resources, credible receiving owner, responsibilities and contribution arrangements.
- **Success and continuity:** measurable success criteria, evidence for the next decision, and handover and maintenance arrangements.

Delivery. Partners carry out the work, test it with users and arrange handover. The phase ends with a **completion brief** recording results against success criteria, supporting evidence, deviations, reuse and maintenance conditions, and proposed next steps. Accepted results and the brief enter the portfolio for review and reuse.

Challenge records will specify the applicable start and completion dates, key review points and resources, using existing programme documents where they serve this purpose. Challenges already under way will continue under their agreed EDCOM arrangements; the DC-EDIC and work-package leads will consolidate their progress and remaining milestones through programme management.

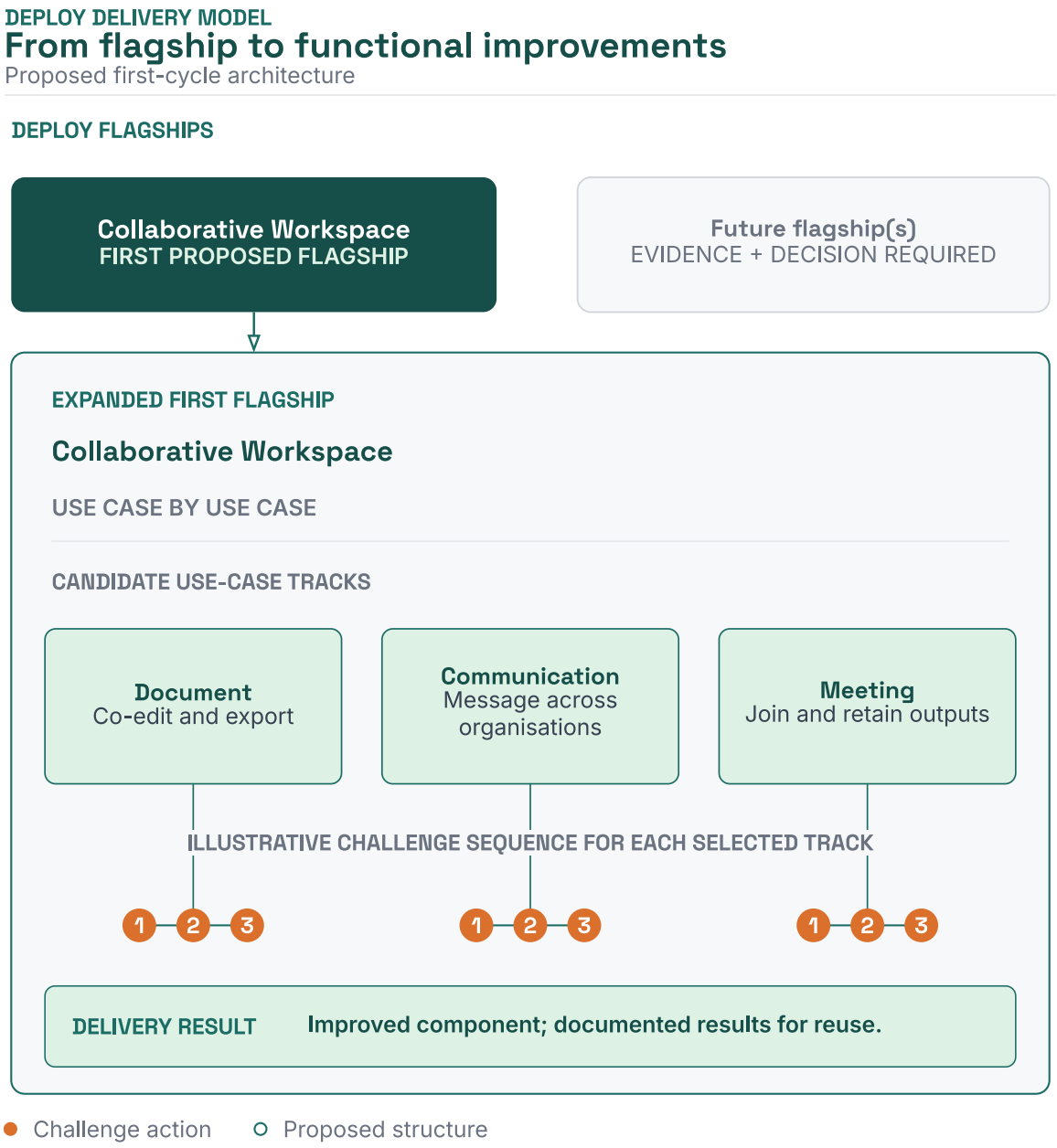
Governance responsibilities:

- **DC-EDIC** validates the launch brief on strategic grounds and reviews the completion brief against the same criteria: Strategy and portfolio alignment, European added value, common principles (Section 2.4) and expected results. The Director and team act within the approved frame and delegations, with independently secured capacity.
- **Delivery partners** manage technical, organisational and contractual arrangements and prepare both briefs within their mandate and applicable technical governance. The receiving owner validates technical conformity and takes over the result under the delivery agreements.

The Assembly retains decisions reserved by the Statutes and Section 8.7. EDCOM scope and resources remain subject to its governance and contractual procedures. Detailed work package 4 (WP4) criteria will be consolidated through the programme.

DINUM and ZenDiS will lead initial EDCOM campaigns with the DC-EDIC, seeking wider participation. Collaborative Workspace remains the priority. Subject to confirmed design and capacity, a use case may span several challenges. The proposed first Document campaign could, for instance, align openDesk Notes and Docs release cycles, then consider BlockNote improvements in accessibility, mobile use, suggested edits and reliable AI assistance for collaborative editing across products and configurations.

Within the official DC-EDIC portfolio, a challenge in another domain may provide a bounded preparatory proof after Future Domains Roadmap qualification and a decision confirming scope, owner, resources and evidence requirements. A new flagship requires an explicit portfolio decision.



Flagships define the focus; use cases set the goal; challenges remove specific obstacles.

Challenges are launched for selected tracks. Their number and sequence depend on confirmed blockers, campaign design and capacity. Future flagships need their own supporting evidence and decision.

Figure 3: Each flagship develops through selected user journeys. Challenges improve existing components to remove the obstacles those journeys reveal.

4.5 First-Cycle Results And Learning

Deployment proofs will test representative journeys with trustworthy permissions and data. They will identify barriers to regular use and repeat deployment, covering integration, migration, accessibility, training, support, organisational ownership, procurement and user confidence. Relevant tests will include legacy formats, critical workflows and web-desktop interoperability.

The DC-EDIC will work with participating teams to collect and consolidate feedback from users across countries, including beyond products' home markets. Teams will use existing project channels to show how this feedback informs priorities and fixes,

and explain significant needs left unmet. Findings will inform subsequent challenges and portfolio reviews, while product owners retain responsibility for their roadmaps.

For journeys reaching regular use, partners will also document the path from need to procurement, operation and support. The review will specify the arrangements actually used, observed costs, maintenance responsibilities and the conditions enabling another organisation to repeat the journey.

By the end of 2027, Deploy will have produced:

- regular cross-organisational document collaboration in participating organisations, with accountable operators, and reuse of the shared reference in a further organisational setting;
- reference proofs for at least one additional qualified use case, tested across several controlled environments;
- challenge results accepted and integrated by receiving owners, removing defined blockers in real use;
- reusable interoperability, migration, security, user experience and support evidence.

Connect will reuse the improvements and evidence with adopters, integrators and other ecosystem actors. Material dependency risks go to Maintain.

During 2027, one Future Domain, or two if capacity permits, may enter discovery. Each requires verified European demand, a credible user and contributor coalition, accountable preparation, a plausible reusable intervention and identified resources. Discovery must protect delivery capacity for Collaborative Workspace and other first-cycle commitments.

The end-2027 review will decide which journeys to continue, whether the model can be repeated, which assets to add to the shared reference base and whether a Future Domain is ready to become a flagship. Material new programmes follow Section 8.7 decision rights and remain subject to available capacity.

5. Maintain: Critical Dependencies And Stewardship

5.1 Purpose

Maintain helps make digital commons dependable infrastructure by identifying critical projects and organising action to secure, repair and sustain them. It builds European understanding of shared dependencies and strengthens stewardship through proportionate action. Funding is one instrument of this broader function.

Stewardship keeps maintenance, security, support and continuity responsibilities visible and credible over time. Software ownership and direct maintenance remain with the relevant projects, communities, companies or operators.

Maintain will combine real-deployment evidence, maintainer knowledge, security signals and public-interest priorities to identify dependencies. It will assess where European coordination can reduce shared risk or improve adoption confidence, choose proportionate support or continuity responses and review results. Assessments may change deployment choices, trigger remediation or continuity work, connect projects to support or identify targeted financing needs.

EU-STF is the first identified financing route for targeted maintenance. Other remediation or continuity actions require an existing partner route or additional funding.

The initial DC-EDIC contribution to the European Digital Public Infrastructure Steward Organisation envisaged by the Commission will be preparatory design input. Under the Director's responsibility, its scope, expected output and means will be agreed with the Commission and interested Member States and communities, taking account of existing stewards.

The first cycle will test whether dependency evidence leads to credible interventions that improve resilience with a proportionate burden on maintainers. The link between deployment needs, interventions and results must remain visible.

5.2 Critical Dependency Intelligence

Critical Dependency Intelligence will regularly assess dependencies important to the DC-EDIC portfolio and Member States. Assessments will combine evidence such as prevalence in real use cases, functional importance, vulnerability, governance health, maintainer capacity, public interest and the feasibility of useful intervention.

The DC-EDIC remains accountable for the questions addressed, assessment-method integrity and links to portfolio decisions. Member States and observers, EDCOM partners, security actors and maintainers provide specialist assessments under appropriate delivery arrangements.

Each assessment must state sources, uncertainty and limits, drawing on maintainer knowledge through proportionate reporting and engagement. It may identify candidate interventions; funding follows the applicable governance and resource process.

For selected cases, the assessment, funded work package or deployment record will specify responsibilities, maintenance and security arrangements, support routes, continuity gaps and a review point. Maintainers and delivery partners will carry out resulting actions.

For selected dependencies, the assessment will also examine how user organisations and service providers contribute to upstream projects: funding, maintenance time, fixes or other contributions agreed with maintainers. It will make visible any continuity needs that remain unmet.

The DC-EDIC will maintain exploratory exchanges with the JRC and relevant Commission services as their open-source assessment work develops.

5.3 EU-STF Pilot

The EU-STF Pilot will test whether targeted European financing improves the resilience, security and continuity of selected critical digital commons.

It covers the full funding cycle: bottom-up dependency identification and assessment, informed by an open ecosystem consultation; agreement on bounded work packages with trusted maintainers; contracting; implementation support; and review. Based on an open survey, selection will consider relevance, prevalence, vulnerability, public interest, feasible activities, maintainer expertise and European added value.

The Sovereign Tech Agency will operate the pilot within EDCOM, leading technical design, assessment, work-package development, contracting, delivery support and operational reporting under the agreed mandate. The DC-EDIC will be accountable for the European public-value hypothesis, governance safeguards, links to dependency and deployment evidence, and evidence-based review.

Drawing on the Sovereign Tech Agency's experience with core digital infrastructure, the pilot will target open digital base technologies. It complements Deploy, which starts from shared use cases and functional adoption barriers.

The pilot has three proportionate decision points:

- **Design review:** the DC-EDIC aligns with the Sovereign Tech Agency on criteria, safeguards, operating arrangements and the evidence model.
- **Cohort selection:** the DC-EDIC Director coordinates the selection of the proposed cohort with the Sovereign Tech Agency following its technical analysis.
- **End-2027 review:** the Assembly of Members, regularly informed of progress, evaluates the pilot and decides whether and under which conditions it should scale.

During 2026-2027, the pilot will move from design to a bounded cohort launch and initial evidence collection. Funded work may continue into 2028; the end-2027 review will use the evidence then available. Findings can inform future European and Member State decisions, including possible longer-term maintenance capacity.

Operating evidence can inform the Commission's proposed Open Source Maintenance Instrument. Financing experience contributes to the wider stewardship agenda in Section 5.1.

5.4 First-Cycle Results

By the end of 2027, Maintain will demonstrate that:

- deployment and ecosystem signals can produce trusted dependency assessments;
- a bounded maintenance cohort can be selected and contracted through a credible partner-carried route;
- initial delivery evidence is useful, maintainer administrative burden remains proportionate and maintainer experience is documented;
- selected assessments, funded work packages and deployment proofs identify credible maintenance, stewardship and continuity responsibilities;
- evidence supports a decision on developing European maintenance capacity further.

The EU-STF Pilot and Critical Dependency Intelligence will launch separately during the first cycle. The end-of-cycle review will also assess Maintain's coherence as a system. Critical Dependency Intelligence should inform priorities and interventions; EU-STF will test targeted financing. Statutory support routes and EDCOM outputs will make maintenance and continuity responsibilities visible. The instruments should share evidence, apply consistent criticality criteria and, where practical, use a common intake and assessment route.

6. The 2026-2027 Portfolio

6.1 Eight Expected First-Cycle Results

The first cycle has eight expected results. Seven organise delivery: three Connect products form a collective-action system; two Deploy products link a flagship to its delivery instrument; two Maintain products connect dependency intelligence with a first financing pilot. The eighth, the Future Domains Roadmap, manages options across the portfolio.

Each has a defined purpose, identifiable users or decision-makers, a tangible result expected by the end of 2027 and a review point. EDCOM-backed services, proposed pilots and future-option decisions differ in maturity, resources and delivery arrangements. All must produce useful results.

The seven operating products follow the common impact requirement in Section 9.2. The Future Domains Roadmap is assessed separately for the quality and usefulness of its prioritisation and preparation decisions.

Product or service	Function	Tangible result by the end of 2027
Community Network and Local Nodes	Connect	A working participation network and selected voluntary nodes help connect real cases with actors, expertise and contribution opportunities.
one-stop shop and expertise hub	Connect	A usable intake and routing service brings qualified European needs and contribution offers to a credible next step.
State of Digital Commons	Connect	A concise annual synthesis of needs, initiatives and lessons informs portfolio, contribution or governance decisions, with targeted updates when useful.
Deployment Challenge Programme	Deploy	Bounded challenges remove adoption blockers through accepted, integrated and used improvements, reusable assets and clear handover to a receiving owner.
Collaborative Workspace Flagship	Deploy	Organisations collaborate across organisational boundaries on documents in routine work, with accountable operators, and reuse the shared reference in a further organisational setting. At least one additional qualified use case is tested across controlled environments.
Critical Dependency Intelligence	Maintain	Recurring assessments inform deployment, security, maintenance and funding decisions.
EU-STF Pilot	Maintain	A bounded maintenance cohort is selected and contracted through a credible partner-carried route, generating initial evidence.
Future Domains Roadmap	Cross-portfolio	Future domains meeting preparation conditions receive evidence packs and explicit launch, prepare, defer or stop decisions.

Detailed product charters remain working management instruments, recording current users, named accountability, delivery arrangements, resources, evidence, risks and next review points.

6.2 Sequencing

Delivery actors will organise work in stages around the smallest useful proof, existing funding, confirmed partner capacity and evidence needed for later decisions. Budgets and timetables will reflect these conditions, starting with EDCOM funding.

Connect will start through EDCOM work package 2 (WP2). Community engagement and local nodes will open participation routes; the one-stop shop and expertise hub will develop intake and referral; the State of Digital Commons will provide the initial evidence base. Linked from the outset, they will turn engagement into qualified cases and clear contribution opportunities within one operating system.

Deploy will start through EDCOM challenges, initially focused on digital workspaces. They will improve existing open-source components for qualified use cases and can progressively strengthen the Collaborative Workspace Flagship. The Sovereign Tech Agency will operate EU-STF, the first Maintain pilot, within EDCOM. Connect will bring cases and actors to these instruments; they will return deployment and maintenance evidence to the portfolio.

Critical Dependency Intelligence and EU-STF remain separate first-cycle instruments. The end-2027 review will assess whether they should work as a more coherent system.

The Future Domains Roadmap develops alongside delivery. Domains beyond the first flagship can enter active preparation or delivery once evidence, ownership and capacity are established through its decision process.

6.3 Future Domains Roadmap

As open-source technologies and markets evolve during and after the first cycle, the roadmap identifies potential domains for assessment of shared demand, European added value and delivery capacity. Illustrative families include:

- cloud, hosting and network services;
- coding and developer tools;
- desktop operating systems and virtualisation;
- mobile application distribution;
- AI-enabled open-source capabilities;
- other strategic digital commons proposed by Member States.

Selection and commitment follow the roadmap decision process, using six common criteria:

- shared demand and intended users;
- European added value, relation to the statutory mandate and complementarity with relevant European initiatives, including the EU Open Source Strategy;
- existing assets, actors and contribution capacity;
- adoption, interoperability and security barriers;
- the smallest useful proof;
- ownership, resources and maintenance path.

Active work requires a defined decision need, accountable preparation and confirmed capacity. Every theme must reach an explicit **launch**, **prepare**, **defer** or **stop** decision. A material new programme follows the appropriate Assembly or delegated governance route. Regular decisions keep the roadmap current and resolve outstanding themes.

7. Conditions For Trustworthy Adoption

7.1 Cybersecurity

Cybersecurity is a condition of adoption from discovery to handover. Every deployment or maintenance intervention identifies the security and software-supply-chain baseline, assurance methods, responsibility for vulnerabilities, means to remedy them and expected continuity arrangements.

Evidence remains proportionate to the use case and legal context. Relevant obligations and practices may include the Cyber Resilience Act, NIS2, GDPR, supply-chain security, secure hosting, privacy and security by design, zero-trust principles and independent assessment. Existing European schemes and ENISA work will be reused where appropriate. Assurance will also consider cryptographic agility and readiness for future cryptographic transitions where relevant.

Identifying vulnerabilities must lead to credible means of remedying them. Where stronger requirements create work for communities or maintainers, the intervention examines the capacity and resources they need to meet them.

A security concern can reshape or stop a pilot. The concern, evidence, responsible actor and review process are recorded to inform that decision.

7.2 Artificial Intelligence

AI can reduce the cost of producing code, tests, documentation, translations and support. It can help analyse vulnerabilities, understand large codebases and operate complex systems. This changes open-source economics and practice, potentially allowing smaller communities and public-interest projects to achieve results previously requiring much larger teams.

Faster code production can also increase review and maintenance workloads. Generated contributions may weaken provenance or community trust. AI-enabled features can create dependencies on models, data, compute, licences and external services, and change users' understanding of responsibility when systems propose or perform actions.

A dedicated AI workstream will open where AI materially changes a portfolio activity, user journey, software-production process, security posture, maintenance burden or strategic dependency. It will state the expected value, human-control arrangements, data and compute needs, licensing and provenance conditions, security implications and community effects. Assessment of a material AI-enabled capability also covers exit conditions and costs if a model, provider, service or compute source becomes unavailable or unacceptable.

Collaborative Workspace AI assistance must demonstrate reliability, remain attributable and reviewable, and keep consequential actions under human control. In Maintain, AI may support code understanding, testing and vulnerability handling while preserving maintainer judgement and manageable community review workloads.

The Future Domains Roadmap can assess AI-enabled open-source capabilities as a possible domain. A general AI programme requires a later portfolio and governance decision.

7.3 Interoperability, Portability And Exit

European reuse depends on interoperability. Assessments will address legal, organisational, semantic and technical interoperability, drawing proportionately on the European Interoperability Framework and applying Interoperable Europe Act requirements where relevant. Open source supports transparency, reuse and adaptation; technological neutrality and effective switching also require open standards, compatible interfaces and evidence from deployment and substitution tests. The Strategy favours open standards and formats, explicit interfaces and documented conformance methods. Deployment assessments will establish whether data, permissions and relevant workflows retain acceptable integrity and usability across components and organisations. Cross-organisational or cross-country proofs will check consistent meanings for shared information and access rights, with explicit mappings where practices or languages differ.

Procurement arrangements and reference configurations will make migration assumptions visible, preserve auditability and favour practically replaceable dependencies. Portability includes the ability to leave a solution: a substitution test is often more informative than a general claim of modularity.

Transition evidence will separate the cost of leaving the incumbent and reaching a neutral, usable interface from the cost of adopting the target solution. This keeps total transition effort visible without attributing accumulated lock-in to the alternative.

The DC-EDIC may publish profiles, requirements and test evidence during the first cycle. A future certification or label role requires separate legal, governance, technical, market-neutrality and maintenance analysis and an appropriate decision.

Where deployment reveals a standards gap, the DC-EDIC will raise it through the relevant European or international standardisation and interoperability channel and support the competent process.

7.4 User Experience And Organisational Adoption

Usability determines whether people can adopt an interoperable, secure capability. Each proof includes representative users and considers accessibility, design, multilingual use, onboarding, support and the complete journey's coherence.

Organisational adoption receives the same rigour as code. Management support, political confidence, procurement readiness, training, migration planning and operating responsibility can determine success. As it moves to regular use, each participating organisation will identify its adoption lead and the resources needed to support users. Evidence will distinguish a functioning prototype from a capability the organisation can operate.

7.5 European Ecosystem And Economic Capacity

Digital commons rely on viable organisations as well as code. Communities and foundations provide governance and knowledge; maintainers sustain the technical base. Open-source companies, integrators, hosters and support providers turn components into dependable services. Public administrations and other anchor users bring demand, evidence and continuity.

Shared software foundations allow several companies to offer integration, hosting, training and support services. The aim is to widen buyers' effective choice and enable European providers, particularly SMEs, to develop their business across countries using common resources.

The first cycle strengthens their combined delivery capacity around concrete use cases. Transparent requirements and procurement methods can help European SMEs and integrators meet demand. Reference implementations can reveal support or integration gaps; maintenance interventions can improve trusted maintainers' working conditions; reusable evidence can lower entry costs in another national market.

The DC-EDIC will use open contribution routes, objective criteria and conflict-of-interest safeguards. Ecosystem growth will be demonstrated by European actors' ability to deliver, support and sustain capabilities users need.

8. Delivery, Governance And Resources

8.1 Operating Accountability

Statutory responsibilities remain unchanged. The Assembly sets direction, adopts the Strategy and annual work programme, supervises implementation, and decides material changes and the portfolio's future at the end of 2027.

Members exercise governance and voting rights, provide statutory contributions and support DC-EDIC work, including uptake, user feedback and national digital commons ecosystems. Observers may contribute to Strategy activities, provide ad hoc support and promote uptake and ecosystem development under the Statutes.

The Assembly appoints the Advisory Board with an equitable distribution of stakeholders with relevant expertise. The Board advises the Assembly and may challenge evidence and advise on priorities, risks and review decisions. Executive and statutory authority remain with the Director and Assembly.

The Director manages the DC-EDIC day to day and implements Assembly decisions. With the team's support, the Director allocates work within the approved budget and work programme, manages implementation risks, reports progress and submits proposed amendments to the Assembly.

Each active product or service will have a named DC-EDIC point of accountability, held by the Director or a designated team member. This person ensures alignment with the Strategy, reviews results and brings material issues to the appropriate decision level. Operational delivery may be led by an implementation partner, such as the Sovereign Tech Agency for EU-STF, under agreed responsibilities and reporting arrangements.

The designated DC-EDIC representative will have direct access to beneficiaries and delivery teams, access to expertise to assess user needs and technical feasibility, and authority to agree and adjust priorities with partners within approved mandates and resources. Partners retain technical choices and delivery methods. These arrangements enable action on user feedback and delivery obstacles.

The Director will give the Assembly regular, concise updates on progress against expected results, resources, material risks, partner dependencies and decisions due for review. Material deviations or commitments outside the validated Strategy follow the appropriate Assembly procedure. Routine delivery remains with the Director, designated team members and implementation partners, according to their agreed responsibilities.

The DC-EDIC acts directly where shared accountability, governance or evidence requires a responsible European body. Elsewhere, it coordinates, supports or tests partner delivery. Activities lacking a credible owner, delivery route or resources will be deferred.

8.2 EDCOM: The First Delivery Programme

EDCOM provides the first funded delivery programme: WP2 for Connect, WP3 for Maintain and WP4 challenge campaigns for Deploy. Annex E details the correspondence.

EDCOM provides funded capacity and delivery partnerships for the first cycle. Partners contribute expertise and evidence to Strategy development; the Assembly

adopts the Strategy and the Director implements it under Sections 8.1 and 8.7. Partners retain their technical and contractual responsibilities under the Grant Agreement.

EDCOM outputs retain their contractual scope, timetable and governance. The Strategy links them to expected results and shared evidence through the existing Grant Agreement and delivery structures. Results outside EDCOM require separately authorised delivery and resource arrangements.

8.3 Participation, Membership And Enlargement

Enlargement is a priority of this Strategy: bringing in additional Member States will help the DC-EDIC reach critical mass within the European Union and broaden its financial, technical and human resources.

Member States, observers, countries interested in joining and ecosystem actors can contribute to specific work. Communities, maintainers, companies, researchers, civil society and European institutions may propose use cases, host pilots, contribute code, methods or expertise, involve users, fund work or provide in-kind support.

The DC-EDIC will explain contribution needs, who assesses proposals and how contributors receive feedback. A proposal becomes a commitment when its work, responsibilities, resources, timetable and conditions are approved under applicable rules.

An interested country can assess cooperation by joining a pilot or contributing expertise. The consortium gains use cases, skills and further organisations for testing solutions.

Membership brings participation in Assembly decisions on priorities, budget and Strategy, with statutory rights and responsibilities. Observers contribute under their status; other actors use transparent contribution or delivery arrangements. Open outputs benefit the wider ecosystem under Section 8.6. During the first cycle, the DC-EDIC will explain these opportunities through ongoing work and achieved results.

Practical cooperation will support both engagement with additional countries and the path from participation to membership. The DC-EDIC's partnerships work will connect companies, including SMEs and integrators, with shared projects around users' needs, building on initial use cases and national ecosystems. Its work programme will develop these relationships within available capacity and transparent participation arrangements.

8.4 Resource Discipline And Concentration

The portfolio combines the DC-EDIC core team and budget, EDCOM-funded capacity for initial Connect, Deploy and Maintain instruments, confirmed Member State and observer contributions, and the expertise, infrastructure and pilot environments of implementation partners described in Section 8.1. The mix varies by product and service.

Protect core functions and choose priorities. Resources first cover statutory operations and portfolio accountability. The DC-EDIC must retain internal skills for user-centred product leadership and informed technical judgement, programme and grant control, Member State and ecosystem coordination, communication and institutional knowledge. The annual work programme then concentrates effort on

limited activities selected for expected benefit, European added value, readiness and confirmed partner capacity.

Confirm resources before starting work. Each product or service requires the DC-EDIC accountability defined in Section 8.1, a credible delivery lead or route, proportionate confirmed resources and access to relevant users or decision-makers. The applicable budget, work programme, product charter or delivery agreement will identify leads and record agreed funding, staffing and technical resources. One person may be accountable for several products, with explicit responsibility for each.

Contributions enter delivery plans once scope, owner, timetable and conditions are confirmed. Each is counted once; expressions of interest require confirmation. Insufficient resources require a narrower objective, staged work or a deferred launch.

Use enlargement to extend proven results. New members' contributions follow the same allocation criteria through the annual budget and work programme. They strengthen shared capacity for a larger membership, extend Connect, Deploy and Maintain results to more countries and, resources permitting, enable work on qualified Future Domains. New members' use cases, expertise, infrastructure or co-funding may accelerate this progression.

Build skills in step with the work. From validation through the first quarter of 2027, the team will establish product leadership, direct user engagement, intake, evidence collection and programme control. Confirmed EDCOM and partner capacity will support first proofs. Additional skills and capacity will be mobilised for validated cases during 2027. The end-2027 review will determine what needs a durable internal, partner or mixed operating arrangement.

8.5 Communication, Dissemination, Advocacy And Cooperation

First-cycle communication will explain the mandate and work, establishing the DC-EDIC as a trusted European reference point on digital commons, open-source adoption and digital sovereignty. It will open participation and enlargement opportunities, use credible evidence to build adoption confidence and influence policy, and report progress, limitations and forthcoming decisions.

The Director ensures coherence both institutionally and in the common narrative, and exercises publication authority subject to Assembly decisions and applicable procedures. Designated DC-EDIC representatives supply activity evidence and source caveats. EDCOM WP1 funds the first communication and dissemination campaign.

Partner communication will use shared messages and brand principles, respecting delivery responsibilities and institutional voices. Partners remain responsible for claims about their own work. Joint communication will specify purpose, lead, attribution, supporting evidence, approval and timetable. The DC-EDIC communication plan will define audiences, responsibilities, channels and frequency.

The Collaborative Workspace flagship will have a distinct programme brand clearly associated with the DC-EDIC, within its broader digital commons mission. Its promise is to help organisations collaborate, deploy and switch solutions through proven shared capabilities. The brand will identify the programme and its shared results;

participating initiatives retain their own brands and delivery responsibilities. The communication plan will define the public name and rules of use.

Assessment will cover reach and outcomes such as qualified contributions, reuse of published methods, new adoption paths, prospective-country engagement and documented follow-up to policy recommendations. The State of Digital Commons and portfolio results provide the principal advocacy evidence.

The DC-EDIC will pursue limited practical links with related EDICs and relevant Interoperable Europe structures for defined use cases, interoperability, reuse or shared evidence. Before creating a parallel mechanism, it will assess reuse, federation or interoperability of existing European services under acceptable governance and access conditions.

It will, for instance, explore cooperation with ALT-EDIC on multilingual capabilities and adoption pathways, potentially including translation, terminology, evaluation or language-technology support for cross-border services. Progress depends on validating the relationship, expected result and technology choices. Every cooperation initiative will identify an accountable contact and review point.

8.6 Access, Reuse And Publication Conditions

DC-EDIC services, infrastructures, events, advisory support and facilities will have open, transparent and non-discriminatory access conditions. Eligibility, priorities, selection criteria, available support and material limitations will be published electronically through an appropriate channel. Restricting an otherwise open activity to members requires Assembly approval.

Selection decisions will explain the shared need, expected benefits across countries and relevant delivery capacity, using proportionate records within existing programme arrangements. The Director will address material gaps in participation through outreach and operational adjustments, reporting issues requiring collective decisions through the existing governance.

Access and contributions will follow proportionate data-protection, security, confidentiality, procurement and conflict-of-interest safeguards. A service opens once responsibility, access, decision authority and sensitive-information handling are clear.

Software jointly developed through the DC-EDIC will by default use licences meeting Article 27 free-software and open-source requirements. Contributors must disclose relevant prior knowledge, third-party components and restrictions early enough to prevent incompatible rights from limiting dissemination or reuse. Non-software outputs will have clear ownership, access, attribution and reuse conditions suited to their nature.

Companion policies will maintain detailed access and intellectual-property procedures. Product charters and delivery agreements will apply them before relevant work or publication begins.

8.7 Decision Rights And Adaptation

The Assembly validates the strategic objective, Connect / Deploy / Maintain architecture, first-cycle portfolio, implementation principles, governance boundaries and reporting model. It retains strategic, statutory and reserved authority. A new

first-cycle flagship, product endorsement, permanent funding mechanism, material resource commitment or substantial change to the Strategy or its perimeter returns to the Assembly through the appropriate procedure.

The Director and team validate readiness to start, evidence for accepting results and next steps under the approved Strategy, budget, work programme and delegations for activities involving central resources or included in the official DC-EDIC portfolio. Independently funded challenges within the agreed strategic framework follow the notification procedure in Section 4.4. Within that perimeter and resource envelope, the Director may adjust milestones, methods, delivery instruments and individual items' scope or next steps in response to evidence. Product reviews cover scope and evidence; decisions are recorded at the competent level.

Implementation partners retain technical assessment, contracting and routine delivery control; EDCOM delivery follows EDCOM governance. Partner-delivered pilots use staged reviews and reporting by exception. The DC-EDIC sets their common mandate, safeguards and evidence requirements and validates operational next steps within the approved frame.

8.8 Timeline

Following adoption by the Assembly on 16 October 2026, the first phase will confirm designated DC-EDIC representatives, delivery routes, initial evidence baselines and the scope of first operational proofs.

During the remainder of 2026 and the first quarter of 2027, the DC-EDIC and partners will:

- establish minimum Connect intake and evidence routes;
- configure the first Collaborative Workspace journey in at least two controlled reference environments and qualify an additional use case for first-cycle testing;
- complete the EU-STF design review and prepare the first bounded cohort;
- confirm initial portfolio baselines, risks and review dates;
- identify the first Future Domains Roadmap themes meeting preparation conditions.

These steps draw on the DC-EDIC team, EDCOM work-package capacity and confirmed partner contributions: WP2 and national counterparts for Connect; WP3 and the Sovereign Tech Agency for EU-STF; WP4 and delivery teams for Workspace. Detailed schedules and allocations will be consolidated through existing programme management and the DC-EDIC work programme, within approved resources. Prospective funding or contributions enter delivery plans only once confirmed. Operational adjustments follow Section 8.7.

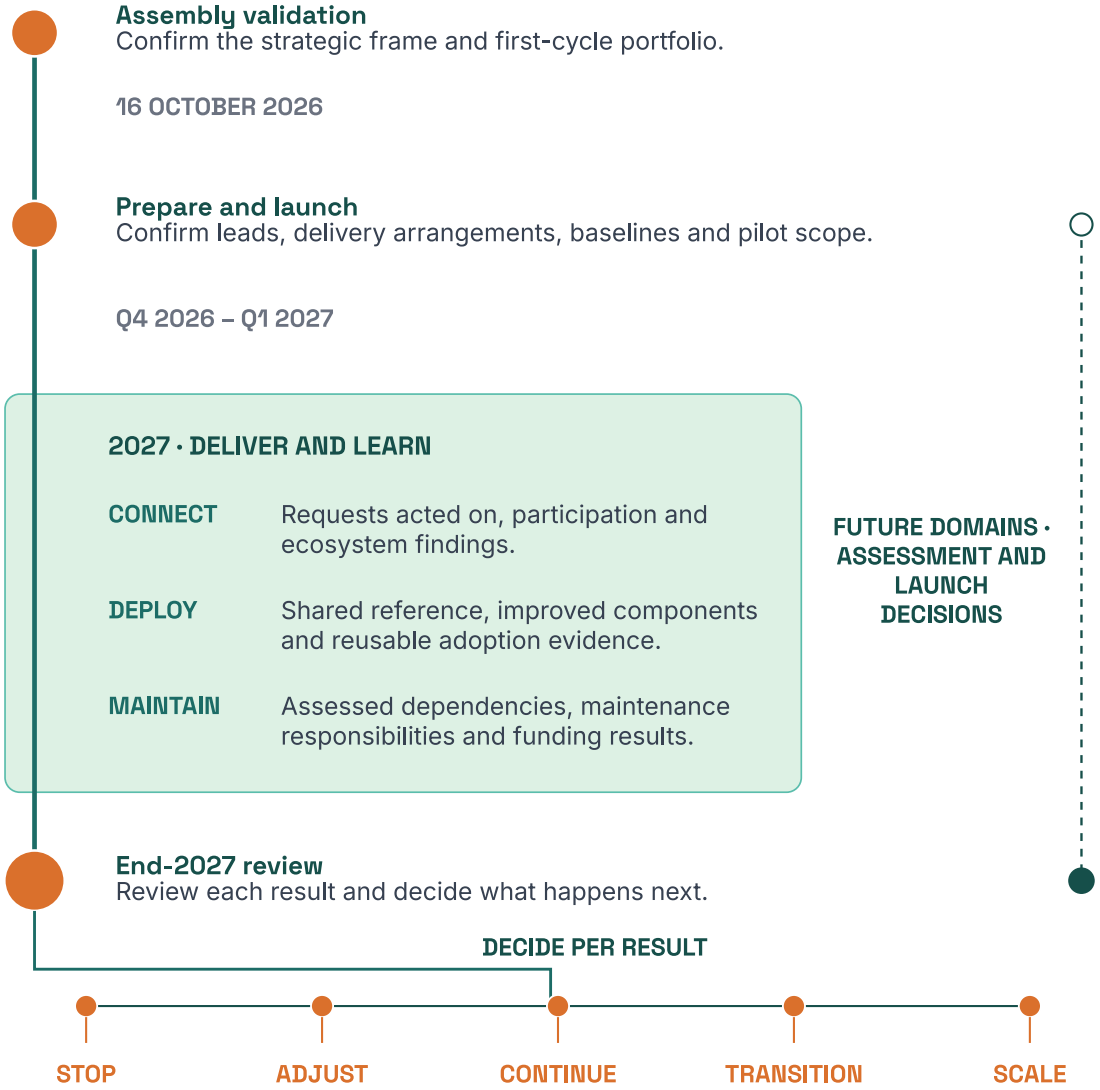
During 2027, Connect services will operate and improve through real cases, and scoped deployment challenges will deliver improvements used in practice. Collaborative Workspace will progress from controlled proofs to regular document collaboration and reuse of the shared reference in a further organisational setting. This phase also includes launch and review of a bounded EU-STF maintenance cohort, recurring evidence publications and explicit roadmap decisions.

The end-2027 review will assess each product against its expected result and decide whether to stop, adjust, continue, transition or scale. Contracted maintenance may extend into 2028 where approved work packages require it. The strategic review will remain on schedule and inform the next Strategy period.

FIRST-CYCLE TRAJECTORY

Deliver, learn and decide what to scale

Proposed sequence · October 2026 to end-2027



Plan for wider use from the start; scale when the results justify it.

This sequence is indicative. Work starts once responsibilities, delivery arrangements and resources are confirmed. Impact objectives are defined as work starts.

Figure 4: The first cycle moves from Assembly validation to delivery and an end-2027 review. Each result is assessed before its next stage is decided.

9. Results, Learning And Scale

9.1 What Success Means

Success means lasting improvements for European actors: problems solved, useful work made possible and better decisions. Three outcome families guide evaluation; activity measures track delivery.

Outcome family	What the DC-EDIC needs to demonstrate	Illustrative evidence
Coordinated action and European capacity	Qualified needs and contributions reach useful next steps; shared evidence informs decisions; European actors build or reuse capacity around real cases.	Time from need to useful next step, confirmed contributions converted into action, evidence used in decisions, cross-country reuse and case-linked delivery capacity.
Adoption and deployment	Organisations routinely use open-source solutions for selected use cases; improved components remove blockers; the shared reference is reused in a further setting.	Regular use confirmed by users and operators, challenge improvements integrated and used, repeat deployment effort, interoperability and migration results, operating and support conditions.
Maintenance and resilience	Dependency intelligence and targeted interventions improve security, continuity, maintainer capacity or adoption confidence through a credible operating model.	Assessments used in decisions, time and burden from case to contract, remediation and continuity evidence, maintainer experience and additionality.

Every product has a tangible 2027 result and a review decision. Section 9.2 explains how intended improvements will be measured.

EDCOM activity and reach indicators remain subject to Grant Agreement reporting. They track delivery and use of funded instruments; the outcome framework assesses the resulting benefits.

9.2 Assessing Real-World Impact

Each operating product will be assessed on improvements for beneficiaries beyond its deliverables. At the start, its lead will define the intended change with beneficiaries. The existing charter will record a baseline, review date and a few simple indicators, with quantified objectives where meaningful, refined as initial measurements become available. Monitoring will be proportionate to resources and stakes.

Indicators may track a procurement route actually used, support capacity available in another country, the effort needed to repeat a deployment, or maintenance resources confirmed beyond initial funding.

The team and partners will test improvements with users in short cycles and adjust priorities from feedback. Usage data and feedback from operators, maintainers and receiving owners will show what improves, for whom, what remains difficult and how far the action explains observed changes. Findings will be dated, sourced and explicit about limitations and disappointing results.

Continuation and expansion depend on benefits relative to costs and the DC-EDIC's contribution. Reviews will distinguish partners' achievements from what the DC-EDIC enabled, accelerated or made reusable beyond what they could reasonably have achieved separately. Costs include coordination and partners' time. Shared results will identify each product's contribution and count once at portfolio level.

Findings will guide improvements, resource shifts or proposals to stop. Expansion also requires repeatable benefits, an accountable owner and maintenance or continuity resources. A technical test may justify a first step; adoption and scale require real-world evidence. Financial and compliance checks complement this evaluation.

9.3 Review And Learning

Review frequency will follow decision needs. Reviews consider results and evidence, user or decision-maker responses, material risks and resources, then ask:

- Are Connect, Deploy and Maintain achieving the outcomes in Section 9.1 and reinforcing one another?
- Are resources concentrated on the highest shared value?
- What did the DC-EDIC make possible, faster, more reliable or reusable across countries, and was it worth the coordination effort?
- Which product stops, adjusts, continues, transitions or scales?

Stopping ends an intervention with insufficient value or evidence; the underlying strategic need returns for a fresh decision on how the portfolio should address it. Adjusting means fixing, improving, narrowing or redesigning the intervention before its next review.

Annually, the Director will submit an implementation report to the Assembly covering the portfolio, material evidence, resources, unresolved risks and proposed amendments. After Assembly approval, it will be transmitted to the Commission under Article 24. The annual activity report is also made public under Article 19.

9.4 Risks

The main strategic risks are:

Portfolio dispersion. Eight products may be read as eight simultaneous programmes. Proportionate scopes, sequencing and activation conditions keep effort focused.

Activity disconnected from adoption. Networks, challenges or pilots may generate activity but little improvement in user journeys or decisions. Every product will be judged against its expected result.

Fragmentation. National configurations, projects or standards may diverge. Shared use cases, interfaces, tests and reusable evidence provide common reference points.

Winner-picking or market capture. Reference implementations may be mistaken for endorsed products. Modular requirements, transparent criteria, substitution tests and conflict-of-interest safeguards preserve neutrality.

Prospective capacity. Delivery may rely on unconfirmed partners, funding or staff. Activation requires named ownership, a credible delivery route and proportionate resources.

Delegated delivery losing strategic control. A partner could become the de facto owner of European priorities. The DC-EDIC defines the mandate, safeguards, evidence requirements and review points, preserving accountability while drawing efficiently on partners' operational expertise.

Maintenance after pilot delivery. Outputs may lack a receiving owner or continuity path. Challenges and pilots require handover and maintenance conditions before launch.

Administrative burden. Governance and reporting may slow intended beneficiaries. Evidence and accountability requirements will be designed with users and maintainers and reviewed for proportionality.

Unfunded security remediation. Stronger assurance may reveal issues lacking a resourced response. Security review must identify the remedy and responsible actor.

Roadmap accumulation. Future themes may become implicit commitments. Active work requires accountable preparation, confirmed capacity and an explicit launch, prepare, defer or stop decision for every theme.

Loss of trust. Overclaiming country support, funding, product readiness or European consensus would weaken the Strategy. Source status and decision authority remain visible.

Existing project and portfolio reporting will record risk likelihood and impact, the accountable owner, mitigation actions, action deadlines and the next review date. The Director and designated DC-EDIC representatives will establish this view during initial implementation, using existing programme records, and update it at product reviews, escalating material risks through the reporting and decision rights in Sections 8.1, 8.7 and 9.3.

9.5 Durability And Scale

The first cycle prepares results for wider use, subject to evidence justifying expansion. Each product will provide:

- an understandable, reusable method;
- evidence of the conditions under which it works;
- an accountable owner or transition route;
- governance and contribution rules;
- a resource and maintenance model;
- a clear next decision.

Scale may mean wider country uptake, repeated delivery in new environments, integration into an established programme, transition to a durable service or adoption by another capable owner. Growth within the DC-EDIC is one possible route.

The end-2027 review will test immediate impact and readiness for wider use. A useful pilot may provide valuable lessons; durable European capacity also requires credible continuity arrangements. A modest first result may justify expansion where method, ownership and demand are strong.

10. Implementation Commitment

This Strategy commits the DC-EDIC to turning European cooperation into capabilities that people and organisations can use.

Seven operating products implement Connect, Deploy and Maintain. Their results will test whether European coordination makes adoption repeatable and critical commons resilient, while preserving solution diversity and choice. The eighth result, the Future Domains Roadmap, identifies later options for explicit decisions. Evidence will inform decisions on what to repeat, fund, sustain or stop.

Different national approaches and open participation by communities and market actors must produce shared results. Cooperation needs action on agreed priorities and clear delivery and maintenance responsibilities. Through this work, Europe will build the capacity to develop, deploy and maintain digital commons collectively and sustainably.

Annex A. Statutory Coverage

This table maps Article 24(2) requirements to the Strategy and shows how outstanding details will be confirmed during implementation. It provides statutory traceability; legal interpretation remains subject to competent review.

Article 24 requirement	Coverage in the Strategy	How details are confirmed
Detailed actions and timeline	Sections 3-6 and 8.8: priorities, expected results, sequence and 2026-2027 timeline. Annex B maps these to Annex V.	The annual work programme and product charters fix product dates.
Tasks, roles and responsibilities	Sections 8.1-8.3: roles of members, observers, the Director, Advisory Board, designated DC-EDIC representatives and delivery partners.	Named assignments and partner delivery arrangements are confirmed before delivery begins.
Resources required for each action	Sections 6 and 8.4: first-cycle resource model, concentration of effort and conditions for starting work. Annexes B and E identify the main statutory and funded delivery bases.	The annual budget, work programme, product charters and delivery agreements confirm allocations and in-kind capacity.
Governance and contributing stakeholders	Sections 2.5, 3 and 8.1-8.6: collective action, governance, participation, access and contribution.	Delegation, publication and participation arrangements undergo the applicable legal and procedural review.
Implementation modalities	Sections 3-8 and Annex E: delivery instruments, EDCOM links, access, reuse and adaptation.	Companion policies, product charters and delivery agreements specify operating procedures.
Milestones, targets and deliverables	Sections 6, 8.8 and 9.3: tangible results, sequence and review. Annex C defines common review criteria.	Product charters specify milestones and reviews; intended improvements and measures are recorded as work starts.
Key performance indicators	Sections 9.1-9.2 and Annex D: outcome families, evidence requirements and initial indicator framework.	Measures are defined as work starts; quantified targets are set where meaningful and refined with initial measurements.
Implementation risks	Section 9.4: main strategic risks and responses.	Product and portfolio management records identify accountable risk owners and operational review dates.
Other relevant aspects	Sections 7 and 9.5: trustworthy adoption, durability and scale. Section 6.3 governs future options.	The end-2027 review informs amendments and the next Strategy period.

Annex B. Correspondence With Annex V Activities

Each Annex V activity is addressed through direct DC-EDIC work, partner delivery or a later option. The relevant product charter, annual work programme, EDCOM arrangement or Assembly decision will specify first-cycle roles, resources and milestones.

Action 1 -- Build a European community for digital commons

Annex V activity	Work in the first cycle	Main delivery instrument or capacity	Decision in the first cycle
1.1 Create a strong public-civic-private partnership	Enable practical contributions around real cases and support voluntary local or thematic nodes.	Community Network and Local Nodes; Member State and ecosystem contributions; EDCOM community activity.	Confirm the minimum node offer, common principles and organisations able to convene participants.
1.2 Organize events and matchmaking	Match needs with expertise and identify potential joint work through targeted exchanges and an open community forum.	Community Network; EDCOM community engagement and event partnerships.	Confirm event arrangements and assess whether participation yields qualified connections and action.
1.3 Promote the use of digital commons	Build awareness, confidence and reuse through credible evidence, practical adoption methods and successful cases. Apply objective criteria when prioritising digital commons.	Shared adoption resources; State of Digital Commons; communication and dissemination activity.	Set audiences, responsibilities, competition safeguards, publication conditions and outcome indicators in the communication strategy.

Action 2 -- Facilitate access to funding

Annex V activity	Work in the first cycle	Main delivery instrument or capacity	Decision in the first cycle
2.1 Create a physical and online one-stop-shop	Run a lean online entry point with physical access through selected events and nodes. Assess needs and contribution offers; direct them to a useful next step.	one-stop shop and expertise hub; Community Network; EDCOM design and prototype baseline.	Validate user journeys, access conditions, service boundaries and quality safeguards before opening.
2.2 Provide support and expertise for fundraising	Help users find relevant funding and experts, including for European, national or maintenance instruments.	one-stop shop and expertise hub; EU-STF where relevant; existing funding actors.	Confirm available expertise; distinguish guidance, application support and funding decisions.
2.3 Coordinate calls for proposals from Member States	Examine common parameters and collective funding arrangements as a later option. Any joint call requires a specific decision on demand, authority and resources.	Future Domains Roadmap; Member State and Assembly work programme.	Explicitly decide to prepare, defer or launch, based on demand, authority and resources.

Action 3 -- Support maintenance, development and scaling

First-cycle stewardship draws on existing Maintain products and partner capacity.

Annex V activity	Work in the first cycle	Main delivery instrument or capacity	Decision in the first cycle
3.1 Provide technical, legal and other advice	Connect users and digital commons with quality-controlled technical, legal, licensing, accessibility, multilingual, governance, business, adoption and stewardship support.	one-stop shop and expertise hub; shared adoption resources; qualified partners and experts.	Define minimum support, transparent access conditions and the quality-assurance method.
3.2 Provide dedicated resources and testing facilities	Identify and assess existing hosting, software forge, testing, experimentation and continuity capacity before creating a shared service.	Partner and Member State facilities; relevant pilot environments; Future Domains Roadmap if new shared capacity is proposed.	Start the service only after confirming recurring demand, an accountable owner, access conditions and a sustainable resource model.
3.3 Gather technical skills for consulting	Connect users with trusted specialist advice, audits, cybersecurity compliance and continuity support through the expertise hub and qualified partners.	Use-case capability map; expertise hub; security and specialist partners.	Confirm expert selection criteria, conflicts-of-interest safeguards, service boundaries and evidence of user value.

Actions 4-5 -- Strategic development and concrete projects

Annex V activity	Work in the first cycle	Main delivery instrument or capacity	Decision in the first cycle
4.1 Strengthen advocacy for digital commons	Target recommendations, engage relevant audiences and follow up using portfolio and ecosystem evidence.	State of Digital Commons; institutional communication and policy engagement.	Confirm editorial responsibility, priority audiences and tracking of recommendation uptake.
4.2 Enhance synergy between related EDICs	Cooperate with related EDICs and relevant Interoperable Europe structures where shared standards, assets or use cases create value. For example, explore ALT-EDIC cooperation on multilingual capabilities and adoption pathways.	Director and Member State institutional coordination; portfolio-specific cooperation subject to counterpart agreement.	Identify a few practical links between organisations, accountable contacts, expected shared results and review points.
5.1 Enhance the development and deployment of digital commons tools	Test focused use cases and produce reusable adoption evidence, preserving solution choice.	Deployment Challenge Programme; Collaborative Workspace Flagship; later initiatives authorised through the Future Domains Roadmap.	Accept, adjust, transition, scale or stop each proof, based on adoption, reuse, ownership and maintenance evidence.

Options After 2027 Within The Wider Statutory Mandate

The end-2027 review and next Implementation Strategy will determine which options proceed in the next cycle, subject to the relevant strategy, governance and resource decisions.

Annex V activity	Possible post-2027 direction
2.3 Coordinate calls for proposals from Member States	Consider coordinated calls or other collective funding once shared demand, authority and resources are demonstrated.
3.1 Provide technical, legal and other advice	Expand common support where first-cycle demand and referral evidence justifies lasting European capacity.
3.2 Provide dedicated resources and testing facilities	Consider shared or federated testing, hosting, software forges or experimentation capacity once recurring demand, access conditions and a sustainable operating model are established.
3.3 Gather technical skills for consulting	Strengthen the European network of qualified experts and specialist support where the first-cycle expertise hub demonstrates recurring needs.
4.1 Strengthen advocacy for digital commons	Inform policy engagement with the State of Digital Commons and portfolio results, with defined audiences and follow-up indicators.
4.2 Enhance synergy between related EDICs	Develop selected cooperation into shared services, standards work or joint use cases once counterpart agreements and shared value are confirmed.
5.1 Enhance the development and deployment of digital commons tools	Launch further flagships or challenge programmes through the Future Domains Roadmap when evidence, ownership and resources support an Assembly decision.

Annex C. Common Portfolio Review Criteria

Product charters remain the detailed management reference for users, scope, delivery arrangements and evidence. Six common criteria guide decisions on all eight expected results:

1. **Strategic relevance:** a clear shared need, fit with the statutory mandate and European added value.
2. **Responsibility:** both a named DC-EDIC point of accountability and a credible delivery lead or arrangement are confirmed.
3. **Impact and evidence:** observed improvements for beneficiaries, product and DC-EDIC contributions, and reliable, traceable sources support assessment at the relevant stage of work.
4. **Resources:** scope matches available DC-EDIC, EDCOM, Member State and partner capacity.
5. **Trust and continuity:** proportionate treatment of security, neutrality, conflicts of interest, support and maintenance.
6. **Next decision:** evidence supports an explicit choice: stop, adjust, continue, transition or scale for operating results; launch, prepare, defer or stop for roadmap themes.

For the EU-STF Pilot, these criteria apply at three first-cycle decision points: design review, coordinated cohort selection and end-2027 review, under the responsibilities in Section 5.3. Technical assessment and routine delivery follow confirmed delivery arrangements unless a material exception requires DC-EDIC action.

Annex D. Indicators And Their Use

The initial set of indicators remains small. Measures should be credible, inform decisions, require proportionate collection effort and resist improvement through activity alone. The framework separates delivery control from strategic impact evidence and accommodates different routes to results.

Evidence level	Question	Illustrative evidence	Decision supported
Activity	Was planned work performed?	Requests handled, workshops held, assessments started or work packages funded.	Monitor delivery and operating burden.
Output	Was a usable result produced?	A defined next step for an assessed need, deployment method, reference configuration, dependency assessment or completed maintenance work.	Accept, rework or complete the result.
Use and effect	Did the result improve a real decision, journey or capability?	Evidence used in a decision, journey completed, blocker removed, method reused, procurement route clarified or maintainer need addressed.	Continue, adjust or stop the approach.
Scale-readiness	Can the result be repeated efficiently in a new setting?	Reusable method and assets, confirmed owner, resource model, support and maintenance arrangements.	Transition, extend, defer or prepare scale-up.
Durable impact	Did European digital commons capacity improve over time?	Cross-country reuse, stronger delivery capacity, improved resilience, maintained dependencies or practical convergence.	Shape the next Strategy and longer-term investment.

Connect measures may include time from a qualified need to a useful next step, contributions put into action, guidance reuse and evidence used in decisions.

Deploy measures may include regular use in participating organisations, improvements integrated and used, blockers removed, migration effort, component substitution, and deployment cost and time in a further setting.

Maintain measures may include time and burden to move a maintenance case to support, remediation and continuity outcomes, maintainer experience and additionality: what support achieved beyond what would otherwise have happened.

Participation and enlargement measures may show whether engagement with a prospective country yields a substantive contribution, reuse, pilot participation, an observer role or a documented next step towards formal status.

Cross-country reuse and confirmed delivery capacity indicate scale-readiness. Activity measures support operations; outcome evidence shows what changed.

Where relevant, the DC-EDIC will map verified portfolio evidence to the Commission's open-source monitoring framework, including procurement-support reuse, maintained dependencies and standards-related contributions. Definitions and attribution will be agreed before aggregation. Existing evidence records will be used, keeping service activity distinct from adoption and durable impact.

Annex E. EDCOM Contribution To The Strategy

EDCOM is the Strategy's first funded delivery base within a wider portfolio. WP2 primarily supports Connect, WP4 supports Deploy, and WP3 supports Maintain and longer-term prioritisation. These tables distinguish their contributions and link grant activities to expected results, responsibilities and conditions.

Connect -- WP2 community and evidence activities

EDCOM activity	Strategy product or service	Contribution to the Strategy	Responsibilities and conditions
WP2 community engagement, event partnerships, Open Community Forums and local-node support	Community Network and Local Nodes	Qualifies requests, organises contributions, connects actors and gathers real-case evidence through engagement. Node participation remains voluntary, supported by funded coordination, common principles and contact-point arrangements.	EDCOM governs delivery and outputs; the DC-EDIC retains Strategy-result accountability and statutory governance.
WP2 one-stop-shop, expertise-hub and capacity-building activities	one-stop shop and expertise hub	Connects needs to assessment, expertise, adoption or maintenance support, funding, pilots or contributions. Funded portal, guidance and capacity-building outputs form the initial service base.	Service boundaries, quality safeguards, available expertise, DC-EDIC accountability and post-grant responsibility require confirmation.
WP2 recurring State of Digital Commons work	State of Digital Commons	Informs portfolio, dependency and Assembly decisions through the report, with common source and evidence requirements.	Editorial responsibility, evidence access and conditions for sustaining a recurring product require confirmation.
WP2 European Digital Commons Research Award	State of Digital Commons and Community Network	Brings relevant research and ecosystem perspectives into evidence and policy discussion, supporting existing Strategy products.	The Award remains a distinct EDCOM output with its own governance, timetable and reporting obligations.

Deploy -- WP4 challenge campaigns

EDCOM activity	Strategy product or service	Contribution to the Strategy	Responsibilities and conditions
WP4 challenge campaigns, initially focused on digital workspaces	Deployment Challenge Programme and Collaborative Workspace Flagship	Organises targeted functional improvements to existing open-source components from qualified use cases, through discovery, development, release and evaluation. Results must be accepted, with reusable evidence, an owner to receive them and clear maintenance conditions.	DINUM and ZenDiS lead campaigns and seek other Member State and observer participation. The flagship may also require ecosystem or non-EDCOM contributions.

Maintain -- WP3 dependency work and the EU-STF Pilot

EDCOM activity	Strategy product or service	Contribution to the Strategy	Responsibilities and conditions
WP3 strategic mapping and roadmap work	Critical Dependency Intelligence and Future Domains Roadmap	Produces recurring dependency assessments and informs roadmap decisions through mapping, including evidence on maintainer capacity, support needs and continuity gaps.	Changes to WP3 scope, method or delivery responsibilities follow EDCOM governance and applicable contractual procedures.
Sovereign Tech Agency-operated EU-STF activity within EDCOM	EU-STF Pilot	Tests a bounded model for bottom-up identification, assessment, selection, funding and remediation, including operating efficiency. The Sovereign Tech Agency leads operational design and delivery; the DC-EDIC retains accountability for European public value, safeguards and strategic review.	The DC-EDIC aligns with the Sovereign Tech Agency on design. The DC-EDIC Director coordinates cohort selection with the Agency following its technical analysis. The Assembly is informed during delivery and decides at the end-2027 review whether and under which conditions the pilot should scale.

This alignment operates within the current Grant Agreement. Changes to EDCOM tasks, responsibilities or resources follow EDCOM governance and applicable contractual procedures.